

HYBRID DOMINANT SUSPENSIONS

F/G and Fmaj7/G — two slash chord voicings that suspend dominant function without the tritone's urgency. The "floaty" approach to V before resolution.

DOMINANT SUSPENSION 1

F/G

G bass | F-A-C on top

= G9sus4 (1, b7, 9, 4 from G)

1 (G)

b7 (F)

9 (A)

4 (C)

FLOATY

QUESTIONING

OPEN

NO TRITONE

THE SOUND

No major 3rd (B) = no tritone = no sharp dominant urgency. The sus4 (C) and 9 (A) float above the G bass. Suspends you in an ambiguous, open space before resolution.

RESOLUTION

F/G → Cmaj7: the suspended 4th (C) can stay as the root of Cmaj7, while A falls to B (the maj7) or G. The resolution is smooth and inevitable but not urgent.

Dual function: Can function as V9sus4 (dominant prep) OR as Gm11 (ii- or vi- context) — the lack of tritone makes it harmonically ambiguous. Context determines function.

DOMINANT SUSPENSION 2

Fmaj7/G

G bass | F-A-C-E on top

= G13sus4 (1, b7, 9, 4, 13 from G)

1 (G)

b7 (F)

9 (A)

4 (C)

13 (E)

BRIGHTER

EXTENDED

SHIMMER

13 ADDS LIGHT

THE SOUND

Adding the major 7th of F (E = the 13th from G) brightens the sound considerably. More "sparkle" than F/G while keeping the suspended quality. The E is very close to the B we'd expect in a standard G7.

RESOLUTION

Fmaj7/G → Cmaj7: all upper voices resolve smoothly — E stays as the maj7 of Cmaj7, C becomes the root, A stays as the 6th or falls to G. Ultra-smooth voice leading.

Function: Always dominant — the 13th adds enough "reach" that this chord doesn't have the same ambiguity as F/G. Used when you want suspended warmth plus extended brightness before resolving.

COMPARE: THREE WAYS TO APPROACH G → C RESOLUTION

G7

Tritone (B↔F) creates strong, urgent, direct tension. The "expected" dominant. Snaps into resolution. Maximum clarity, minimum subtlety.

F/G

No tritone — suspended, floating, questioning. Drifts into resolution rather than snapping. Smooth and ambiguous. R&B, gospel, neo-soul.

Fmaj7/G

Suspended but brighter — the 13th adds shimmer without adding tritone urgency. The most extended and lush of the three. Jazz, neo-soul, smooth R&B.

THE SUSPENSION ARC — FROM OPEN TO RESOLVED



The sus chord can resolve directly to Cmaj7 (skipping G7) OR move to G7 first for additional tension before final resolution — both are valid approaches with different emotional intensities.